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NEWSPAPER 30th OCTOBER, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

44th WEEK



YEMEN ... FORGOTTEN COUNTRY

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

30th OCTOBER, 2018

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Stop the war

The Saudi-led attack in Yemen must cease, and with it the humanitarian crisis

While Saudi Arabia is struggling to salvage its image in the aftermath of the murder of journalist Jamal Khashoggi inside its consulate in Istanbul, another human rights crisis triggered by its actions confronts the kingdom. According to the United Nations, the war on Yemen, waged by a Saudi-led coalition for over three years with American support, has pushed 14 million people, about half of the country's population, into "pre-famine" conditions. So far, Saudi Arabia has had a free run in Yemen. Despite mounting criticism of its handling of the attack on one of the poorest Arab countries, Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, the main architect of the war, has evaded international pressure to cease hostilities. During the course of the war, the humanitarian crisis in Yemen has progressively worsened. Saudi Arabia started the attack in March 2015 after Shia Houthi rebels captured parts of Yemen, including the capital city Sana'a. Riyadh saw the Houthis as Iranian proxies and was worried they would establish stable rule in its backyard. For the sake of legitimacy, the Saudis claimed they were fighting on behalf of the globally recognised government of Yemen, led by President Abdrabbuh Mansour Hadi who is reported to be residing in Riyadh. But the war has reached a bloody stalemate as the Houthis still remain powerful in northern Yemen and the government controls the southern parts, including Aden.

The conflict has already killed over 6,000 civilians and injured 10,000 more. Unable to defeat the rebels militarily, the Saudi coalition has imposed a blockade on the country, worsening Yemen's food and medicines scarcity. Half of the country's medical facilities are not functional. And at least 22 million people are in need of humanitarian assistance, of whom 14 million are extremely dependent on aid for survival. Besides, there was a deadly cholera outbreak in the country that has affected at least 1.1 million people. None of this has deterred Saudi Arabia from continuing to pound Yemen. It hasn't eased the blockade even after the UN warned of a famine. The international community, which has rightfully criticised Riyadh over the Khashoggi case, failed to act while Yemen was being methodically destroyed. This war has to stop. If Saudi Arabia has geopolitical concerns about Iran's growing influence, it should address them directly with Tehran, not by punishing the people of Yemen. It must immediately cease the bombing campaign, lift the blockade and allow food and medicine supplies into Yemen. This will clear the way for talks between the Yemeni government and the rebels. The obvious lesson of the last three years of this disastrous conflict is that there is no military solution to the Yemen crisis. The sooner this is heeded, the better it will be for Yemen's people.

2 Stop the war

The Saudi-led attack in Yemen must cease, and with it the humanitarian crisis. While Saudi Arabia is struggling to salvage its image in the aftermath of the murder of journalist Jamal Khashoggi inside its consulate in Istanbul, another human rights crisis triggered by its actions confronts the kingdom. According to the United Nations, the war on Yemen, waged by a Saudi-led coalition for over three years with American support, has pushed 14 million people, about half of the country's population, into "pre-famine" conditions. So far, Saudi Arabia has had a free run in Yemen. Despite mounting criticism of his handling of the attack on one of the poorest Arab countries, Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, the main architect of the war, has evaded international pressure to cease hostilities. During the course of the war, the humanitarian crisis in Yemen has progressively worsened. Saudi Arabia started the attack in March 2015 after Shia Houthi rebels captured parts of Yemen, including the capital city Sana'a. Riyadh saw the Houthis as Iranian proxies and was worried they would establish stable rule in its backyard. For the sake of legitimacy, the Saudis claimed they were fighting on behalf of the globally recognised government of Yemen, led by President Abdrabbuh Mansour Hadi who is reported to be residing in Riyadh. But the war has reached a bloody stalemate as the Houthis still remain powerful in northern Yemen and the government controls the southern parts, including Aden.

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Effect of policies and politics of
developed and developing countries on
India's interests, Indian diaspora.



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- War on Yemen waged by Saudi-led coalition for over three years with American support, pushed 14 million people, about half of the country's population, into pre-famine conditions.
- Saudi Arabia started the attack in March, 2015 after Shia Houthi rebels captured parts of Yemen, including the capital city, Sana'a.
- Saudi sees Houthis as Iranian proxies and it was worried that they would establish stable rule in its backyard.
- The war reached a stalemate as the Houthis still remain powerful in northern Yemen and the Govt. controls the southern parts, including Aden.



ONE OF THE BIGGEST HUMANITARIAN CRISIS!



6 There was deadly cholera outbreak in the country that affected at least 1.1 million people.

- 1** Already 6,000 civilians killed and 10,000 injured.
- 2** Saudi imposed blockade on the country, worsening Yemen's food and medicine's scarcity.
- 3** Half of the Country's medical facilities are not functional.
- 4** 22 million people are in need of humanitarian assistance.
- 5** 14 million are extremely dependent on aid for survival.

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE?



- 1 International community should pressurise Saudi Arabia.
- 2 If Saudi Arabia has geopolitical concerns about Iran, it should address them directly with Iran.
- 3 It should immediately cease the bombing campaign.
- 4 It should lift the blockade and allow food and medicine supplies into Yemen.

The talks between Yemeni Govt. and Rebels is the need of the hour!

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SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



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